

copa.life

Icon & Visual

Style Bible

Icon System · Colour Rules · Geometry · Shape Language · AI Generation Guide

01	Visual Identity	What this game looks like, its cultural references, and the three decisions that define it.
02	Core Design Principles	Eight rules that govern every visual decision in the system.
03	Icon System Audit	Three tiers of icons, their status, and icon-by-icon assessment.
04	Geometry Rules	Viewbox standards, stroke weights, grid, corner radius, optical balance.
05	Shape Language	Organic vs geometric, silhouette complexity, visual weight standards.
06	Color Rules	Full palette with HEX values, semantic assignments, disabled/hover/active states.
07	Icon Construction Rules	Fills, outlines, shadows, gradients, lighting, perspective — all explicitly defined.
08	Do / Don't Examples	Hard rules as decision-ready binary statements.
09	AI Generation Guide	Positive prompts, negative prompts, and style keywords for each icon tier.
10	Consistency Report	Every inconsistency found, severity rated, with specific fix recommendations.

WHAT THIS GAME LOOKS LIKE

copa.life belongs to a very specific and rare visual category: **retro-digital football ephemera**. It reads simultaneously as a 1970s Turkish football programme, a 1990s Panini sticker album, and a present-day indie roguelite. None of those three things are usually found together, which is exactly what makes the aesthetic work.

The game's visual DNA comes from:

- **Turkish and Southern European football culture of the 1970s–80s:** warm cream paper, brick red, dark green. The colours of a match-day programme left in the sun.
- **Soviet-era sports design:** dense monospace data, uppercase labels, no decorative softening, information presented with the bluntness of a training schedule.
- **British football card collecting** (Panini, FKS, Top Trumps): tiered card rarity, bordered card frames, parchment backgrounds, a "power" number as primary currency.
- **Independent game design of the 2010s** (Nuclear Throne, Balatro, Into the Breach): roguelite structure expressed through deliberate visual austerity, where limitation reads as style.

THE THREE DEFINING DECISIONS

DECISION 01

The paper background is alive

`#f3ead2` warm cream with a radial dot grid at 6px intervals and a paper texture PNG at 2.8% opacity. This is not decoration — it places every element on a physical surface. Remove it and the game becomes generic.

DECISION 02

The ink is green, not black

`--ink: #26402f`. Every border, most text, and all UI chrome derives from a dark forest green. Combined with the cream background, this is a colour combination with deep roots in Italian football typography and archival print. It is the single most distinctive characteristic of the system.

DECISION 03

Typography performs as data display

`--mono` (Inter in monospace mode) is used for almost all label copy: stats, round numbers, letter-spaced UPPERCASE tags, minute counters. This creates constant visual tension between the human warmth of paper texture and the cold precision of monospace HUD. That tension is the game's personality.

P 1

Print, Not Screen

Every element should look like it could have been printed. No glows, no lens flares, no real-time light sources. Depth comes from weight and contrast, not shadows or gradients.

P 2

The Ink Is The Brand

`#26402f` appears on borders, text, scoreboard backgrounds, button active states, section headers. It is the backbone. Every new element should default to this colour before reaching for anything else.

P 3

Red Means Consequence

`#d6543a` is used exclusively for: debt, danger, loss, opponent UI, quick-start action, and the brand logotype. Red should never appear in an idle, neutral, or positive state.

P 4

Gold Is Achievement

`#e6ad2e` is the mustard-gold of trophies, score highlights, and currency badges. It appears on price tags, active rounds, the trophy fixture, and progress bars. Always surrounded by dark backgrounds.

P 5

Zero Border Radius Is A Rule

`*{border-radius:0!important}` is declared globally. Every explicit border-radius is a deliberate exception that must be earned. Rectangularity is the baseline. Icons must follow this.

P 6

Dense Is Polite

Font sizes go as small as 7px for secondary labels. Padding is minimal. This is a game for players who want information density. Icons reinforce this by being specific, not approachable.

P 7

Uppercase Labels Define Zones

Every section header, stat label, position badge uses `font-family:var(--mono); text-transform:uppercase; letter-spacing:1-3px`. Icons sit inside this system and must feel compatible with it.

P 8

Animation Is Functional

Animations exist for one reason: to communicate what happened. The die spins on roll. The VS glitches to suggest tension. The debt pulses to signal urgency. Decorative animation does not exist in this system.

THE THREE TIERS

TIER A Card Art Icons — 64×64 viewbox

Examples: sponsor, sale, bargain, academy, cut, yacht, tax, trophy_unlock

`stroke="currentColor" · stroke-width="2.2" · stroke-linecap="round" · stroke-linejoin="round" · Fill is currentColor at opacity=".08"-.15` for enclosed shapes only · Organic, narrative paths.

✓ **Status: Well-designed and consistent. These icons are the gold standard for the system. The `currentColor` inheritance means they respond to card tier colours correctly.**

Known issue: No small-size variant. When rendered at max-width 42px in collection cards, the 2.2 stroke at the original viewbox looks slightly heavy.

TIER B Position Role Icons — 28×28 viewbox

Examples: GK (goalframe), DEF (shield+line), MID (crosshair), WNG (arrow), FWD (concentric circles)

`stroke="currentColor" · stroke-width="1.8"` · Pure geometric. Rendered at 18×18 physical size.

✓ **Status: Excellent. Conceptually precise, shared metrics, correct colour inheritance. The goalkeeper is a goalframe — the simplest possible encoding of the role.**

TIER C Howto Step & Shout Button Icons — Mixed viewboxes

Examples: pitch, formation dots, dice, trophy, star, chairman, briefcase-lock, cross, injured figure, playing cards

Mixed viewboxes (26×30, 46×30, 34×34, 32×36, 30×30, 32×42 ...) · Mixed stroke-widths (1.4, 1.5, 1.6, 2.2) · Hard-coded off-palette colours.

⚠ **Status: Most inconsistent tier. Needs standardisation. Details in Section 10 (Consistency Report).**

ICON-BY-ICON STATUS

ICON	CONTEXT	STATUS	ISSUE
sponsor, sale, bargain, academy, cut, yacht, tax	Card art	✓ Works	—
GK, DEF, MID, WNG, FWD (position)	Position labels	✓ Works	—

ICON	CONTEXT	STATUS	ISSUE
Slot silhouettes	Draft pitch	⚠️ Acceptable	Fill-only paradigm vs stroke system — documented exception
Roll die SVG	Roll button	⚠️ Exception	Hard-coded red fill — should use <code>#8e2d20</code> not <code>#c0392b</code>
Trophy, lock, hat (inline)	Labels	✓ Works	—
Football pitch (hw01)	Howto	⚠️ Simplify	46×30 non-square viewBox, stroke 1.4
Chairman bust (hw04)	Howto	⚠️ Simplify	Body paths too complex for this scale
Injured figure (hw05R)	Howto	✗ Redesign	Anatomical detail illegible at 22px render
Elite badge polygon	Shop	✗ Redesign	10×10 fill-only polygon — completely different paradigm
Flame (shout: Yüklən)	Sim	⚠️ Fix colours	Off-palette #ef4444 → should be #d6543a
Arrows (shout: Öndə Bas)	Sim	⚠️ Fix colours	Off-palette #4ade80 → should be #3f9a57
Snowflake (shout: Tempoyu Düşür)	Sim	⚠️ Fix colours	Off-palette #60a5fa → should be #2f6f9e
Shield (shout: Skoru Koru)	Sim	✓ Works	—

CANONICAL VIEWBOX STANDARDS

CONTEXT	VIEWBOX	PHYSICAL RENDER	STROKE-WIDTH
Card art (shop, collection)	64 64	42–58px	2.2
Position role labels	28 28	18px	1.8
Howto step icons ← standardise	32 32	24–32px	1.6
Shout button icons ← standardise	24 24	18–20px	1.8
Inline label icons (trophy, lock)	16 16	11–13px	1.5

Rule: Viewboxes must be square. Non-square viewboxes produce layout instability and inconsistent optical weight when icons are placed side-by-side.

INTERNAL GRID

All icons should be constructed on an implicit 8px grid within their viewbox. For a 32×32 viewbox, the usable grid is 8 columns of 4px. Key anchor points: 4, 8, 12, 16, 20, 24, 28.

Leave **10% padding** inside the viewbox on all sides. For 32×32: content lives within

3.2, 3.2 to 28.8, 28.8 — practically, use 4 to 28.

STROKE WIDTHS

2.2**64 × 64 VIEWBOX**

Card art. Appears as ~1.5px at 48px render.

1.8**28 × 28 · 24 × 24**

Position icons, shout buttons. Legible at 18–20px.

1.6**32 × 32 VIEWBOX**

Howto icons. Balanced at 24–32px render.

1.5**16 × 16 VIEWBOX**

Inline label icons. Minimum legible weight at 11–13px.

Rule: Never mix stroke widths within a single icon. Secondary detail strokes that need de-emphasis should use `stroke-opacity=".5"` or `opacity=".45"` rather than a lighter stroke-width.

CORNER RADIUS

- **Default:** No `rx` attribute on rectangles. Sharp corners.
- **Card/frame shapes:** `rx="2"` at 64×64 (represents a physical card edge). `rx="1.5"` at 32×32.
- **Never:** `rx="50%"` for rectangular shapes. Use `<circle>` for circles.
- **Indicator dots:** `<circle>` elements only.

OPTICAL BALANCE

Icons that use geometric shapes (shield, circle, square) must be optically centred, not mathematically centred. A shield path must appear to sit at the vertical centre even though its visual weight pulls to the body — compensate by shifting the baseline up by 1–2px.

MINIMUM DETAIL SIZE

At 32×32 viewbox: no stroke or gap narrower than 1.5 units. At 64×64: no stroke narrower than 2 units. Details finer than this render as mud at target sizes.

ROUNDED VS ANGULAR

The system is **primarily angular with selective rounding**. This mirrors the global CSS philosophy (`border-radius: 0` as default).

SHAPE TYPE	CORNERS	EXAMPLE
Structural shapes (rectangles, borders, frames)	Sharp	Card borders, pitch outline, receipt
Human / organic elements	Curves	Faces, bodies, vegetation, sails
Motion / flow elements	Curves	Arrows, footballs, wind lines
Data / information elements	Sharp	Grids, books, scorecards, briefcases

A trophy cup is allowed curves at its bowl but its base and handles are straight. A football pitch has sharp corners. A human silhouette has curves throughout.

ORGANIC VS GEOMETRIC

Card art icons lean organic: they are narrative scenes drawn with flowing, illustrative strokes. They resemble quick pen sketches of physical objects.

Position role icons are fully geometric: they encode tactical concepts through pure form. No illustration — pure abstraction.

New icons should decide their register: a howto-section icon explaining game mechanics belongs closer to the illustrative register. A functional UI icon belongs to the geometric register.

SILHOUETTE COMPLEXITY

CONTEXT	MAX PATHS	RULE
Card art (64×64)	5–12	Fine for 48px+ display
Position icons (28×28)	3–5	Minimal — geometric only
Howto icons (32×32)	4–8	Must be recognisable at 24px
Shout button icons (24×24)	2–4	Must be instantly readable at 18px

VISUAL WEIGHT STANDARDISATION

All icons within the same context must share similar visual weight. Currently, the howto icons fail this: the medical cross (2 lines) reads far lighter than the chairman bust (6+ paths). The standard for howto icons should be:

Target: 6–10 path segments, occupying roughly 40% of the viewbox area. Test at 24px physical size — if you can't identify the icon's concept in 1 second, simplify.

PRIMARY PALETTE

				
PAPER #f3ead2 Page background, card backgrounds	PAPER 2 #fdf6e2 Component backgrounds	INK #26402f Primary text, borders, headers	INK 2 #5f7361 Secondary text, labels, metadata	LINE #d8caa3 Borders, dividers
				
RED #d6543a Danger, opponent, consequence	BLUE #2f6f9e Information, links, draws	GREEN #4f9d5f Goals, positive outcomes	MUSTARD #e6ad2e Prices, achievements, highlights	GOOD #3f9a57 Win states, positive values

OFF-PALETTE REPLACEMENTS

Critical: The following Tailwind colours appear in howto and shout icons. They do not belong in this system and must be replaced.

WRONG (TAILWIND)	CORRECT (COPA.LIFE)	CONTEXT
<code>#4ade80</code>	<code>#3f9a57</code> (--good)	Pitch, field, positive, arrows
<code>#ef4444</code>	<code>#d6543a</code> (--red)	Danger, attack, flame
<code>#fbbf24</code>	<code>#e6ad2e</code> (--mustard)	Trophy, achievement, flame inner
<code>#60a5fa</code>	<code>#2f6f9e</code> (--blue)	Snowflake, cool, calm
<code>#94a3b8</code>	<code>#5f7361</code> (--ink2)	Secondary details
<code>#fb923c</code>	<code>#c0813f</code> (--bronze)	Injury, warning

STATE COLOURS

STATE	TREATMENT
Disabled	<code>opacity: 0.4</code> on the icon — never change its intrinsic colour
Hover	Parent element manages hover. <code>currentColor</code> icons inherit automatically.
Active / Lit (.lit)	<code>background: var(--navy)</code> + <code>color: #fff</code> . <code>currentColor</code> icons become white.
Pause / Warning	<code>background: var(--red)</code> . Button handles state; icon inherits.

FILLS

CONTEXT	FILL RULE
Card art icons	<code>fill="currentColor"</code> <code>opacity=".10"-.18"</code> for enclosed shapes only. Creates volume without competing with stroke.
Position role icons	No fill. Pure stroke. <code>fill="none"</code> always.
Howto icons	One flat fill per icon maximum, at <code>opacity=".85"-.9"</code> . Use correct palette colour directly.
Shout icons	No fill except where structure requires it. Use <code>currentColor</code> so lit state works correctly.

STROKES

All icons use stroke. `fill="none"` is the default unless explicitly overriding.

Stroke must always be: `stroke-linecap="round"` · `stroke-linejoin="round"` · consistent weight per context · `stroke="currentColor"` — never `stroke="black"` or any hard-coded colour.

WHAT IS PROHIBITED

TECHNIQUE	REASON
Drop shadows	Destroys print quality. Paper texture creates implicit depth.
Gradients inside icon paths	Visual noise. Icons are flat. Gradients are a different medium.
Textures within icon paths	Texture exists at page level only. Icon surfaces are flat.
3D perspective drawing	Not used anywhere in the system. Layering (overlap) is acceptable; vanishing-point perspective is not.
Highlight reflections	No white dots on spheres, no rim lighting. The canvas football is the only exception.
Hard-coded stroke colours	Never <code>stroke="black"</code> or hex. Always <code>currentColor</code> for theme/hover inheritance.
Mixed stroke widths within one icon	Use <code>stroke-opacity=".5"</code> for de-emphasis instead.

SPECIAL CASES

THE ROLL DIE

The only icon with a hard-coded fill colour. Justified because it is a physical object being rolled, not an interface symbol. Change `fill="#c0392b"` to `fill="#8e2d20"` for palette alignment. Document as the single "object icon" exception.

SLOT SILHOUETTES

The only fill-only icons in the system. Justified because silhouettes communicate form through mass, not line. All use `fill="currentColor"` + animated transform. No new animated icons should deviate from this paradigm.

✓ MUST DO

- ✓ Use `stroke="currentColor"` so icons inherit their context's text colour
- ✓ Use `stroke-linecap="round" stroke-linejoin="round"` on all strokes
- ✓ Design within a square viewbox (32×32 for howto, 24×24 for buttons)
- ✓ Leave 10–12% padding inside the viewbox on all sides
- ✓ Represent concepts abstractly — a goalkeeper is a goalframe, not a person
- ✓ Use sharp corners for structural shapes, curves for organic/human shapes
- ✓ Fill sparingly at low opacity (0.10–0.18) for structural depth only
- ✓ Keep stroke weight consistent within each icon tier
- ✓ Test icons at their actual render size before committing
- ✓ Use system palette colours (#26402f, #d6543a, #e6ad2e, #3f9a57)
- ✓ Make silhouettes readable as a pure black shape with no detail
- ✓ For howto icons: one concept per icon, one focal shape

✗ MUST NOT DO

- ✗ Use Tailwind colours (#4ade80, #ef4444, #fbbf24, #60a5fa) — these are off-palette
- ✗ Hard-code `stroke="black"` or `stroke="#000"` — always `currentColor`
- ✗ Use drop-shadow, box-shadow, or filter on icons
- ✗ Use gradients inside icon paths
- ✗ Mix stroke-widths within a single icon — use opacity for de-emphasis
- ✗ Use non-square viewboxes for any new icon
- ✗ Add `border-radius` to icon container elements
- ✗ Use `fill="white"` as a knockout hack — use compound paths instead
- ✗ Use more than 12 path segments in a single icon (except card art at 64×64)
- ✗ Use vanishing-point 3D perspective in any icon
- ✗ Use more than 2 distinct colours within a single howto icon
- ✗ Use fully-described realistic figures (legs, arms, hair) at button scale

FOR CARD ART ICONS (64×64)

POSITIVE PROMPT

Minimal line illustration icon, hand-drawn SVG style, single thin rounded stroke weight 2.2, no fill except 10% opacity interior wash, currentColor stroke, football culture context, 1970s Turkish sports programme aesthetic, simple gestural sketch, organic curves mixed with straight structural lines, white background, no gradients, no shadows, no colour except black stroke and very light grey interior fill, clean vector art, editorial illustration style, 64x64 pixel icon, two to eight paths maximum

FOR POSITION / FUNCTIONAL UI ICONS (28×28)

POSITIVE PROMPT

Pure geometric icon, minimal SVG, single stroke weight 1.8, no fill, rounded linecap and linejoin, abstract symbolic representation of concept, football tactics diagram style, chalkboard schematic, 28x28 viewBox, monochrome, currentColor, three to five elements maximum, clean sharp paths, no decoration, no gradients, information design aesthetic

FOR HOWTO STEP ICONS (32×32)

POSITIVE PROMPT

Simple explanatory icon, SVG line art, rounded stroke weight 1.6, one primary flat colour fill at high opacity, 32x32 viewBox, 10% padding, football game illustration, game manual style circa 1985, one central concept, four to eight path segments, hand-crafted imperfect line quality, warm colours from a limited palette, not digital-clean, printed programme illustration style

NEGATIVE PROMPT (ALL CONTEXTS)

NEGATIVE PROMPT — APPLY UNIVERSALLY

photorealistic, 3D rendered, gradient, shadow, glow, neon, modern flat icon, material design, iOS style, fluent design, rounded rectangle corners, lens flare, reflection, detailed texture, drop shadow, perspective distortion, emoji style, cartoon style, overly cute, complex illustration, more than 12 paths, animation-ready, multiple weights, sans-serif labels embedded in icon, stock icon library style, pixel art, isometric, glassmorphism, neumorphism

STYLE KEYWORDS

retro-football · Turkish sports ephemera · Panini sticker · match programme
archival print · gestural line · editorial illustration · monochrome icon
currentColor SVG · rounded linecap · no fill · ink on paper · warm cream
forest green · brick red · minimal schematic · hand-drawn vector

roguelite game manual · dense information design · Soviet sports graphic
1970s football poster

Issue 01 Off-Palette Colours in Howto and Shout Icons**HIGH**

The howto step icons use `#4ade80`, `#ef4444`, `#fbbf24`, `#60a5fa`, `#94a3b8`, `#fb923c`. These are Tailwind CSS utility colours with no relationship to the copa.life palette. The game's green is `#26402f` / `#3f9a57`, not `#4ade80`. The howto section — the first thing a new player reads — introduces a completely different colour vocabulary than the rest of the game.

FIX

Replace `#4ade80` → `#3f9a57` · `#ef4444` → `#d6543a` · `#fbbf24` → `#e6ad2e` · `#60a5fa` → `#2f6f9e` · `#94a3b8` → `#5f7361` · `#fb923c` → `#c0813f` across all `_HOWTO_SVGs` entries and shout button SVGs.

Issue 02 Non-Standard Viewboxes Across Howto Icons**HIGH**

Current viewboxes: `46×30`, `26×34`, `34×34`, `32×36`, `30×30`, `32×42`, `32×30`, `32×32`, `30×38`, `26×34`, `34×34`. That is 11 different viewbox dimensions across 12 icons. Non-square viewboxes force the browser to letterbox or stretch icons, producing inconsistent visual weight.

FIX

Redraw all howto icons to fit within a `32×32` viewbox. The pitch icon (`46×30`) needs significant simplification — remove penalty box detail, keep only halfway line, centre circle, goal lines.

Issue 03 Mixed Stroke Widths in Howto Icons**MEDIUM**

Current stroke widths: `1.4`, `1.5`, `1.6`, `2.2` mixed across the 12 howto icons. The 2.2 stroke (borrowed from card art) is too heavy at this scale, making those icons look bolder than their neighbours.

FIX

Normalise to `stroke-width="1.6"` across all howto icons. Secondary detail strokes: `stroke-width="1.2" stroke-opacity=".55"`.

Issue 04 Shout Button Viewboxes Not Standardised**MEDIUM**

Current viewboxes: `20×24` (flame), `20×20` (arrows), `20×20` (snowflake), `20×22` (shield). At their rendered size of ~17–18px physical, a 4px viewbox difference changes apparent scale significantly.

FIX

Standardise all four to `24×24`. Redraw the flame within the new viewbox. Additionally convert all fill colours to `currentColor` so the `.lit` state (navy bg, white text) works correctly across all four buttons.

Issue 05 Injured Figure Icon Too Complex at Scale**MEDIUM**

The `hwi05r` icon (injured player in howto step 05) has 5+ path segments describing legs, arms, torso, and head at a `30×38` viewbox rendered at ~22×28px. At this size, the anatomical detail is illegible — it reads as a blob.

FIX

Replace with a stick figure leaning on a crutch (one vertical line, one diagonal, one crossbar). Or: medical cross + simplified running figure with an X through it. 3 paths maximum.

Issue 06 Roll Die Uses Wrong Shade of Red

LOW

The roll die uses `fill="#c0392b"` (hard-coded, Flat UI red). The copa.life deep red is `#8e2d20`. This is the single "object icon" exception in the system and is justified by its prominence, but the shade should match the palette.

FIX

Change `fill="#c0392b"` to `fill="#8e2d20"`. Document this icon as the explicit "physical object" exception.

Issue 07 Elite Badge Uses Fill-Only Paradigm at 10×10

LOW

The elite badge polygon in the shop discount row is a 10×10 fill-only polygon — too small to carry any visual identity and inconsistent with the stroke-based system.

FIX

Replace with a 16×16 SVG using the same star/burst vocabulary as the weekly-best icon, with stroke rather than fill. Use `--mustard` as the stroke colour.

Issue 08 Stale border-radius on .cardtile (Has No Effect)

LOW

The `border-radius: 8px` on `.cardtile` (cards.css) has no effect due to the global `*{border-radius:0!important}`. This creates misleading expectations for anyone reading the CSS.

FIX

Remove the `border-radius: 8px` from `.cardtile`. If rounded corners are ever intentionally desired, remove the `!important` and manage radius explicitly per-component.

Issue 09 Shout Icon Lit State Will Fail for Coloured Fills

LOW

The `.shoutbtn.lit` class sets `background: var(--navy)` and `color: #fff`. Icons using `currentColor` correctly become white. But coloured fill icons (flame, snowflake) retain their hard-coded colours against the navy background, producing inconsistency.

FIX

Convert all shout icon strokes and fills to `currentColor`. Contextual identity is already carried by icon shape + label text + border accent colour. Hard-coded fills are redundant and produce broken lit states.